

Nielsen Norman Group **Heuristic Evaluation Workbook**

Use this workbook to conduct your own heuristic evaluation.

For each of Jakob's 10 Usability Heuristics, look for specific places where the interface fails to adhere to the guideline. Write your recommendations for how to fix those usability issues.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

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DATE: May 15, 2026

PRODUCT: Student Study Planner &
Deadline Tracker

TASK: Evaluation

1

Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

- Does the design clearly communicate its state?
- Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?

Issues

The progress screen displays overlapping numbers and text on top of the green subject blocks which makes it very hard to see what is happening with the data

Recommendations

It must be separated the progress text from the colored cards so that the text can be read easily by the person looking at it.

2

Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

- Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design?
- Do the design's controls follow real-world conventions?

Issues

The word English is spelled wrong as "Enalish" on the completed progress page which does not match the real word that people use in everyday life.

Recommendations

The system creator needs to fix the spelling of the word English so that it matches correct language rules.

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3

User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action?
- Is *Undo* and *Redo* supported?

Issues

The cancel button on the add new session screen is placed directly under the save button in plain text without a box which makes it difficult to press or notice.

Recommendations

It should change the cancel option into a prominent button or place an X icon at the top corner so users can leave the page quickly.

4

Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?

Issues

The calendar screen displays multiple colored dots for tasks but the priority screen uses high, medium, and low labels which creates confusion about how things are categorized.

Recommendations

The app should use the exact same color system for priority across every screen so that the user does not get confused by different formats.

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5

Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

Issues

The task creation screen sets the default year automatically to 1990 which will cause users to accidentally enter the wrong deadline date.

Recommendations

The system must automatically show the current year of 2026 so that the user does not have to scroll through many years to fix it.

6

Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it?
- Does the design offer help in-context?

Issues

The pending tasks screen shows the study items but does not display the actual priority level directly on the cards, forcing the person to look elsewhere to remember the urgency.

Recommendations

The design needs to put the priority label or its specific color directly on every single card so that the person sees the importance instantly.

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7

Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts — hidden from novice users — may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and functionality personalized or customized for individual users?

Issues

The system makes the user manually type every detail into the task screen without offering quick template buttons for common study activities.

Recommendations

The interface should include quick click options for frequent tasks so that the user can finish entering information much faster.

8

Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnecessary elements been removed?

Issues

The task creation page contains too many separate input fields for months, dates, and years all at once which makes the screen look very crowded and messy.

Recommendations

The design should combine all those separate date boxes into one simple calendar pop-up button to keep the screen clean.

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9

Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

Issues

The input fields for creating a task use tiny red asterisks but they do not show clear error messages when a person leaves a required box empty.

Recommendations

The app must display a clear message in bright red text below any empty box to explain exactly what the user forgot to do.

10

Help and Documentation

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

Issues

The settings page only has a notification switch and a logout button but it completely lacks a help section or manual for instructions.

Recommendations

It needs to put a clear help button on the profile page so that people can read instructions when they are stuck.